

PMBOK / PMI | PMB-09

Project Scope Statement

The detailed description of the project and product scope

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Project Scope Statement
Document reference	PMB-09-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Sponsor
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
PMB-08	Requirements Documentation and Traceability Matrix	Source of the scope
PMB-10	Work Breakdown Structure and Dictionary	Decomposes this scope
PMB-07	Scope Management Plan	Governs this document

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Describes in detail the project scope, deliverables, acceptance criteria, exclusions, assumptions and constraints, providing a common understanding among stakeholders and the basis for the scope baseline.
Framework	PMBOK / PMI — Scope Management — Define Scope
Created when	During planning, after requirements are collected
Reviewed / updated	Through change control only, once baselined
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Sponsor
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	The exclusions section does more work than any other. Be specific about what is not included, particularly at organisational boundaries.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- Exclusions are as detailed as inclusions
- Acceptance criteria are measurable and agreed by the accepter before work starts
- Deliverables are described as products, not activities
- Constraints are distinguished from assumptions
- It is detailed enough that two readers would reach the same understanding of what is in scope

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1. Product scope description

The characteristics of the product, service or result. Progressive elaboration is expected — state the current level of detail.

In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.

2. Deliverables

Ref	Deliverable	Description	Acceptance criteria	Acceptor
D-01	400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated	Liquid-cooled racks at 60 kW with rear-door heat exchangers and CDU redundancy at N+1	No unsigned container image can be admitted; every attempt is alerted within 30 seconds	M. Verity, Head of P3O
D-02	Parallel filesystem accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained	Self-service environment provisioning targeting a two-hour request-to-usable time	All-reduce efficiency at or above 92% on three consecutive 256-GPU runs	G. Lindqvist, Service Operations Lead
D-03	400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated	Multi-tenant orchestration with fair-share quota across AI Research, Fraud Analytics and Retail	Independent penetration test closed with no open critical or high findings	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead
D-04	Parallel filesystem accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained	Parallel filesystem tier of 12 PB usable sustaining 1.2 TB/s to the compute estate	Fair-share quota holds within 5% for each tenant under contention	I. Petrova, Data Platform Lead

3. Project scope — inclusions

Area	Included
DXB-1 halls A and B, 2,048 accelerators and the supporting fabric and storage	DXB-1 halls A and B, 2,048 accelerators and the supporting fabric and storage
Facilities, power and cooling works within the Tranche 2 boundary	Facilities, power and cooling works within the Tranche 2 boundary
Platform, MLOps and security workstreams across the Agile Release Train	Platform, MLOps and security workstreams across the Agile Release Train
Platform, MLOps and security workstreams across the Agile Release Train	Platform, MLOps and security workstreams across the Agile Release Train

4. Project scope — exclusions

The most valuable section in this document. Be explicit, particularly at handover boundaries with operations, other projects and third parties.

Excluded	Rationale	Who is responsible instead
DXB-1 halls A and B, 2,048 accelerators and the supporting fabric and storage	Grid capacity at DXB-1 supports Tranche 2 in full, so a second site is not yet justified	V. Chandra, Product Management
Excludes AUH-2, model development and business-unit data engineering	Air cooling would cap density at 12 kW per rack and require 2.4 times the floor area	M. Verity, Head of P3O
Facilities, power and cooling works within the Tranche 2 boundary	Consolidation is the primary source of the benefit case; utilisation across siloed estates averages 31%	G. Lindqvist, Service Operations Lead
Platform, MLOps and security workstreams across the Agile Release Train	Supply chain provenance for AI tooling is weak; admission control is the only enforceable point	H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure

5. Acceptance criteria

Project-level criteria for accepting the project as complete, distinct from deliverable-level criteria.

Ref	Criterion	Measure	Verified by
AC-01	Fair-share quota holds within 5% for each tenant under contention	All-reduce efficiency at 256-GPU scale	F. Mansour, Business Change Lead
AC-02	Storage sustains 1.2 TB/s against a representative training corpus for 30 minutes	Open critical security findings	T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect
AC-03	All-reduce efficiency at or above 92% on three consecutive 256-GPU runs	Median training cycle time	B. Oyelaran, Quality and Assurance Lead
AC-04	No unsigned container image can be admitted; every attempt is alerted within 30 seconds	Tenants onboarded against commitment	N. Ozturk, ML Platform Lead

6. Constraints

Ref	Type	Constraint	Impact on approach
ASM-001	Time / Cost / Resource / Technical / Regulatory / Contractual	Vendor GPU allocation of 2,048 units for Tranche 2 will be honoured at the quoted delivery dates	Tranche 2 completion slips by at least one quarter and contract terms are renegotiated
ASM-002	Assumption	DXB-1 has 6 MVA of usable capacity available to the programme without a utility	Tranche 2 capped at 1,024 GPUs and the AUH-2 site is brought forward two

Ref	Type	Constraint	Impact on approach
		upgrade	quarters
ASM-003	Assumption	Three business units will migrate committed workloads within six months of hall A handover	Utilisation benefit of AED 14.2m over five years is not realised in full
ASM-004	Constraint	Training data classified as Restricted must remain within UAE borders at rest and in transit	Not applicable — this is a fixed constraint on design
ASM-005	Assumption	Liquid cooling maintenance can be absorbed by the existing facilities contract without an uplift	Annual run cost increases by approximately AED 780,000
ASM-006	Constraint	No production change may be made during the Group financial close window, the last five working days of each quarter	Not applicable — planned into the release calendar
ASM-007	Assumption	The existing 400G core has spare port capacity for four additional leaf pairs	Additional AED 2.1m of core switching required and eight weeks of lead time added

7. Assumptions

Cross-reference the assumption log rather than duplicating it in full.

Ref	Assumption	Validate by	Owner
ASM-001	Vendor GPU allocation of 2,048 units for Tranche 2 will be honoured at the quoted delivery dates	30 Sep 2026	E. Santos, Procurement Lead
ASM-002	DXB-1 has 6 MVA of usable capacity available to the programme without a utility upgrade	15 Sep 2026	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead
ASM-003	Three business units will migrate committed workloads within six months of hall A handover	31 Mar 2027	V. Chandra, Head of AI Enablement
ASM-004	Training data classified as Restricted must remain within UAE borders at rest and in transit	Standing	L. Haddad, CISO
ASM-005	Liquid cooling maintenance can be absorbed by the existing facilities contract without an uplift	31 Oct 2026	G. Lindqvist, Service Operations Lead

8. Interfaces and dependencies

Ref	Interface / dependency	With	Nature	Owner
DEP-001	Utility connection uplift to 6 MVA energised at DXB-1	Facilities (external — utility provider)	Utility works order placed; energisation date confirmed but not contractually committed	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead
DEP-002	400G leaf-spine fabric commissioned and NCCL-	WS3 Network fabric	On plan; benchmark gate scheduled	J. Ferreira, Network Lead

Ref	Interface / dependency	With	Nature	Owner
	<i>validated in hall A</i>			
DEP-003	<i>Identity platform provides workload identity federation for cluster service accounts</i>	<i>Enterprise Identity Programme</i>	<i>Identity programme has deprioritised the federation epic; escalated to the Portfolio Board</i>	<i>K. Adeyemi, Security Architect</i>
DEP-004	<i>Parallel filesystem storage tier accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained</i>	<i>WS2 Compute and storage hardware</i>	<i>Benchmark plan agreed with the vendor</i>	<i>I. Petrova, Data Platform Lead</i>
DEP-005	<i>Service operations liquid-cooling runbook and two live drills completed</i>	<i>WS7 Service operations and support</i>	<i>Runbook drafted; drill dates not yet booked with the FM provider</i>	<i>G. Lindqvist, Service Operations Lead</i>
DEP-006	<i>Chargeback rate card approved by the Programme Board</i>	<i>Finance</i>	<i>Second deferral; blocking FY27 business unit budgeting</i>	<i>C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner</i>